

Trees

Trees in flower in May in the park

Hawthorn sometimes called the May-tree



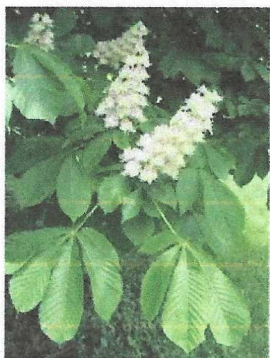
There's a children's rhyme "*Here we go gathering nuts in May*" - bit hard to find nuts in May so it could mean knots (posies) of the mayflower gathered on May Eve ready for celebrating May Day.



The hawthorn has its place in superstition one is that it should never be brought indoors as it would bring bad luck!

Horse Chestnut Tree Several in the park

Providers of our autumn conkers



Cherry Tree

Most of the cherries flowered in April but there's one left still in flower on the top of the bank



Trees

Rowan Tree sometimes called Mountain Ash



The rowan holds a place in Greek mythology and is also prominent in Norse mythology as the tree from which the first woman was made, (the first man being made from the ash tree).

In the British Isles the rowan has a long and still popular history in folklore as a tree which protects against witchcraft and enchantment.



There's even a Scottish song about it.

English Oak or Common Oak



Oak flowers are long yellow hanging catkins distributing pollen in the air

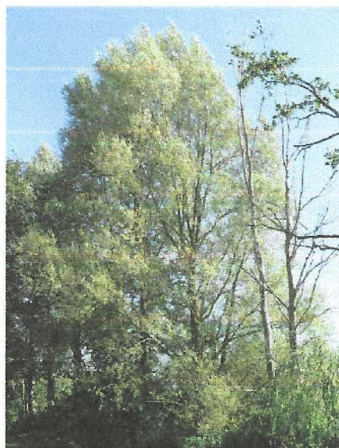
Oaks are the most common tree species in the UK

They are a symbol of strength and survival

"Hearts of Oak are our ships"
A song about the wood from which ships were made in the days of sail



A Crack Willow or is it a White Willow?



The Crack Willow is named after the sound it makes when its branches and twigs fall

The cricket bat willow is a hybrid of the white willow and the crack willow

There are at least 2 in the park on the eastern boundary hedge

The flowers which release numerous cotton-tufted seeds are spread by the wind

